Combat rule – Flying combat · SRD 5.2.1

A creature with a **fly speed** moves through the air. If it is knocked **Prone**, has its speed reduced to **0** or can't move, it **falls**, unless it can **hover**. A fall deals **1d6** bludgeoning damage per **10 ft**, up to 20d6.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Fly speed**: movement in the air.
2. Knocked **Prone** or **immobile**: it **falls**.
3. **Hover**: no fall.
4. Fall: **1d6 / 10 ft** (max 20d6).

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps these rules; falling and landing Prone are unchanged.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how to measure altitude. Fix: track altitude in feet, in 10-ft steps.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the wind, the void underfoot and the horizon line.

Step 1 – Altitude:

Note the height (in 10-ft steps).

Step 2 – Move:

Climbing or descending costs movement, like moving forward.

Step 3 – Attack:

Attacks follow normal rules, range accounts for height.

Step 4 – Fall:

Prone, speed 0 or immobile: you fall unless hovering.

Step 5 – Land:

1d6 bludgeoning per 10 ft (max 20d6), then you're Prone unless you avoid the damage.

Example: a griffon 60 ft up is knocked Prone and falls: 6d6 damage, it lands Prone.

⚠ Common questions:

When do I fall?

Prone, speed 0 or unable to move, without hover.

How much damage?

1d6 per 10 ft, up to 20d6.

What does hover do?

It prevents the fall.

Does a rider fall too?

Yes, DC 10 Dex save if the mount is moved.

Can a flyer be grappled?

Yes, but see the debates.

Altitude for melee?

You must be within reach.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Grappling a flyer

Speed 0 = fall? **Option**: yes unless hovering.

Landing deliberately

Descend without damage. **Option**: yes if landing by movement.

Fly spell ending

A Fly spell that ends. **Option**: immediate fall.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Hover

A hovering creature doesn't fall at speed 0.

Fall

Damage of 1d6 per 10 ft, max 20d6.

Landing

It lands Prone unless damage is avoided.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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